



FAUSTINA BORDONI

The Venetian mezzo-soprano was known for her perfect intonation. Handel wrote five roles for her in his opera company between 1726 and 1728.

The Royal Academy of Music

Establishing himself in a new town house in London's Brook Street, Handel set out not just to write operas—15 in the decade of the 1720s—but to run an opera company. Backed by wealthy